35 **'Akbar's territories were hemmed in by rivals':** Annemarie Schimmel and Stuart Cary Welch, *Anvari's Divan: A Pocket Book for Akbar*, New York: Metropolitan Museum of Art, p. 19.

35 **'seven or eight military zones, commanded by leading nobles':** Khan, *India's Polity in the Age of Akbar*, p. 26.

35 **'to placate the self-sacrificing heroes who had recently entered India':** Thackston (trans.), *The History of Akbar*, Vol. 3, New Delhi: Harvard University Press, 2016, p. 55.

35 **Tardi Beg immediately handed over the custody of Mirza Kamran's second son:** For a detailed analysis of the nobility at Akbar's court, see Khan, *India's Polity in the Age of Akbar*.

36 **'outwardly he had neither rank…nor race':** Kanwal Kishore Bhardwaj, *Hemu: Napoleon of Medieval India*, New Delhi: Mittal Publications, 2000, p. 10.

36 **'evil speaking, plotting and calumny':** Ibid., p. 12.

36 **Abu'l Fazl had to admit that 'ill-starred':** Beveridge (trans.), *Akbarnama*, Vol. 2, p. 71.

37 **'Men of wealth and position had to close their houses':** Abd al-Qadir Badauni, *Muntakhabh al-Tawarikh*, translated and edited by George S. A. Ranking, Vol. 1, Calcutta: Asiatic Society of Bengal, 1898, first edition, Delhi: Idarah-i-Adabiyat-I, 2009 (repr.), p. 549.

37 **'the seeds of the Egyptian thorn, wild dry grass and cowhides':** H. C. Verma, *Harvesting Water and Rationalization of Agriculture in North Medieval India: Thirteenth-Sixteenth Centuries*, New Delhi: Anamika Publishers, 2001, p. 60.

37 **'The writer of these pages':** Badauni, *Muntakhabh al-Tawarikh*, Vol. 1, p. 550.

37 **'two years [of] continual anarchy and terror':** Ibid.

37 **Hemu rode towards Delhi with his enormous army:** Satish Chandra, *A History of Medieval India*, New Delhi: Orient Blackswan, 2007, p. 237.

37 **'While people were crying for bread and taking each other's lives':** Badauni, *Muntakhabh al-Tawarikh*, Vol. 1, p. 551.

37 **removal of powerful Mughal amirs from the region by Bairam Khan:** For a detailed analysis, see Khan, *India's Polity in the Age of Akbar*.

38 **Of the small group…almost all were foreign-born:** John F Richards, *The Mughal Empire*, Part 1, Vol. 5, Oxon: Cambridge University Press, 1995, p. 19.

38 **'esteemed himself at least equal to Keikobad':** Vincent A. Smith, *Akbar the Great Mogul 1545–1605*, Oxford: Clarendon Press, 1917, p. 36.

39 **'When it was reported to him':** Thackston (trans.), *The History of Akbar*, p. 43.

39 **'uniform yellow-gray waste of sterile earth':** Gulbadan, *Humāyūn-Nāma*, p. 94fn.

39 **'sparse grasses and stunted thorn-bushes':** Ibid.

39 **'pugnacious Rajput and Afghan horsemen':** Bhardwaj, *Hemu*, p. 64.

40 **'their blood-dripping blades like hungry lions':** Thackston (trans.), *The History of Akbar*, Vol. 3, p. 119.

40 **he wishes that Akbar had 'unveiled' his true nature:** Ibid., p. 127.

41 **'For eighty years I have been worshipping my God':** Ibid., p. 137.

42 **'peasants and people of low standing':** B. N. Goswami, *Indian Costumes in the Collection of the Calico Museum*, Ahmedabad: The Sarabhai Foundation, 2013, p. 14.

42 **'body was viewed as an integral aspect of the person':** Balkrishan Shivram, 'Court Dress and Robing Ceremony in Mughal India', *Proceedings of the Indian History Congress*, Vol. 66, 2005–06; *Court Dress and Robing Ceremony*, p. 409.

43 **'neither men nor women should wear a tight robe':** Ibid.

43 **Bairam Khan had neutralized the Turani nobility in Hindustan:** For more details explaining Bairam Khan's actions, see Iqtidar Alam Khan, *The Political Biography of Mughal Noble*, New Delhi: Munshiram Manoharlal Publishers, 1991.